US action against Houthis will likely fall short of direct intervention

送信者: EG Daily Brief 受信日時: 2026-10-13 21:27

【メール原文】

US support for Saudi Arabia against the Houthis is likely to remain indirect following the Houthi strike on Saudi Arabia’s international airport. Desp

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summary

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US support for Saudi Arabia against the Houthis is likely to remain indirect following the Houthi strike on Saudi Arabia’s international airport.
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Despite recent resilience, global growth risks remain tilted to the downside amid the ongoing Middle East conflict, with the IMF also warning of the risks posed by a potential correction in AI-related asset prices.
*
US oil output is likely to surpass records as producers cash in on high prices amid Middle East and Russian supply disruptions and China’s export restrictions.
*
A weak response to Panama’s earthquake threatens to undermine President Raul Mulino’s already limited political capital and delay plans to reopen the Cobre Panama mine.
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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, Mexico, the Middle East and North Africa, Panama, Saudi Arabia, energy, geoeconomics, and geo-technology.

the top line

US, MENA Crisis—US support for Saudis against Houthis likely to remain indirect

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US support for Saudi Arabia against the Houthis is likely to remain indirect following the Houthi strike on Saudi Arabia’s international airport.
*
The US is already deeply involved through intelligence sharing, targeting assistance, and munitions. Past operational failures against the Houthis under Trump show the potential downside of direct military action.
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The attack nonetheless raises political pressure on Trump, and Riyadh will likely press for deeper US commitment, especially if conditions deteriorate quickly. Key watchpoints include a potential Trump call to Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, Houthi attacks on oil production infrastructure, and changes to US force posture.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net .

Chart of the Day—IMF slightly upgrades forecasts but warns risks tilted to downside

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The IMF released updated forecasts at the opening of its Autumn meetings in Thailand, making a small upgrade to global growth. The fund highlighted intensifying upside and downside factors, in line with the EG's September Top Calls, which argued that continued conflict in the Middle East tilts global growth risks to the downside.

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The 2026 growth forecast for advanced economies was revised higher led by the UK (+0.3ppts to 1.3%) and Euro area, with a large Germany upgrade (+0.6ppts to 1.3%) amid strong infrastructure and defense spending. French growth was downgraded (-0.2ppts to 0.4%) given ongoing fiscal challenges, while expectations for resilient US growth remained unchanged.

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Middle East 2026 growth forecasts were lowered sharply reflecting the continued conflict, with Saudi particularly impacted (-5ppts to -3.3%). However, India's growth outlook was upgraded (+0.6ppts to 7.0%) with resilient domestic demand and services activity.

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The IMF also warned of the risks posed by a potential correction in AI-related asset prices; read more from EG on the risks here.

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Reach out to geoeconomics@eurasiagroup.net or catch up with us in Bangkok.

US, Energy—US daily crude output likely to surpass 14 million barrels

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US output is likely to surpass a record 14 million barrels per day (bpd) as producers add rigs to drill for more oil.

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US crude and fuel producers are ramping up exports to cash in on high prices caused by Middle East and Russian supply disruptions and China’s export restrictions.

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As Middle East flows fall because of increased Iranian attacks on shipping, the risk of a US escalation against Iran will rise if efforts to keep the Strait of Hormuz open falter.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: ecr@eurasiagroup.net .

Panama—Earthquake response threatens Mulino’s limited political capital

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A 7.7-magnitude earthquake on 9 October damaged roads, bridges, and at least 900 homes, though authorities have reported no deaths.

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The fiscal impact will be manageable. Finance Minister Felipe Chapman said the deficit will stay within its 3.5% target, with borrowing to fund the $100 million (around 0.1% GDP) relief pledge only if insurance, donations, and grants are insufficient. Development banks have also offered up to around $350 million in contingent financing, grants, and credit lines.

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The canal is operating normally, and First Quantum has reported no structural damage to its Cobre Panama mine.

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Complaints of slow relief in rural areas have sparked some protests. With approval around 20%, a weak response could further erode Mulino's already low political capital, which he will need to reopen the mine. Public reaction to the government's plan will shape the mine's future, and reopening is more likely to slip into 2027.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net .

Mexico—Energy demands will complicate US-Mexico trade talks

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Trump is pressing Mexico to buy more US energy and approve more deals involving US companies, adding a sensitive issue to already-delayed USMCA trade talks.

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President Claudia Sheinbaum can most easily respond by modestly increasing US natural gas purchases, easing cross-border infrastructure development, and facilitating selected private investment alongside Pemex and the Federal Electricity Commission, rather than through asset sales or broader liberalization.

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Sheinbaum will probably accept minor regulatory adjustments and ad hoc demands from specific US companies. However, she will be more reluctant to change constitutional provisions that protect state control, making partnerships and supply agreements more likely than a return to the more liberal framework that existed before 2018. The US and Mexico are still likely to sign a limited side agreement in 2026 (60% odds).

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

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13 October 10:45 AM ET—Brazil update. Register here .

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14 October 10:00 AM ET—Israeli election outlook with Ambassador Daniel Shapiro. Register here .

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15 October 11:00 AM ET—USMCA update. Register here .

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22 October 10:00 AM ET— US politics update with former Treasury deputy secretary Derek Theurer. Register here .

eg in brief

Upcoming events:

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13 October: Events: IMF-World Bank meetings in Bangkok through 18 Oct, the Warsaw Security Forum; Data: Argentina CPI and US federal budget balance.
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14 October: Events: US Federal Reserve releases Beige Book and IEA releases monthly oil market report; Data: China trade, PPI, and CPI, US CPI.
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15 October: Data: Eurozone, UK and Japan IP, UK GDP, and US retail sales and PPI.
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16 October: Data: Eurozone CPI, US cross-broder investment, IP, and import price index.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Martina Silva, and Blaise Hanson.

We love feedback! Send us a note at DailyBrief@eurasiagroup.net .

closing quip

“The global economy has been resilient, but that resilience is reaching its limits”—IMF Chief Economist Silvana Tenreyro said at a press conference on Tuesday at the IMF/World Bank meetings.

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